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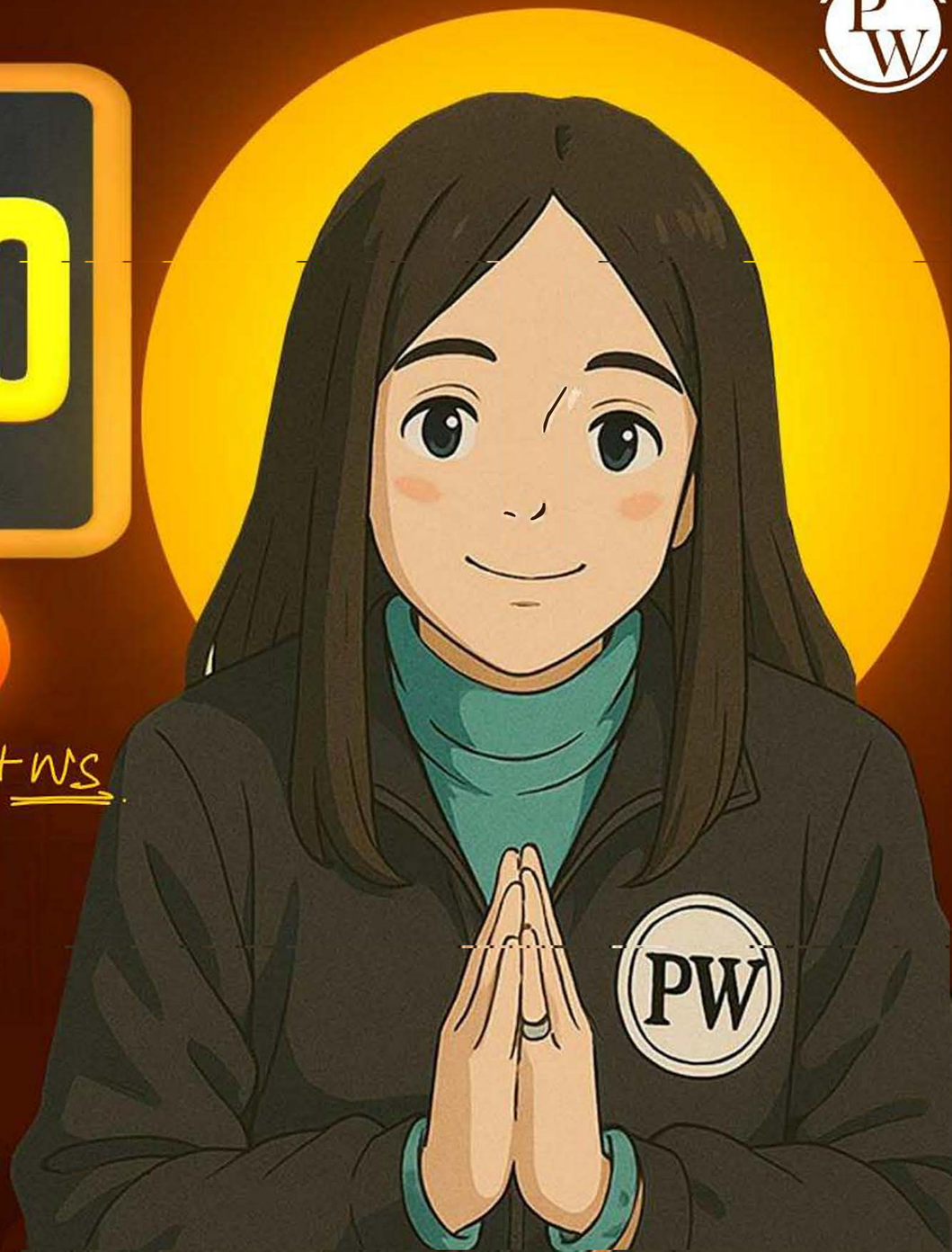
CLASS 12TH 2026

Arts Wallah → class 12th chapters + NS

Keeping Quiet

ENGLISH LECTURE 05

BY-NIHARIKA MA'AM



TOPICS TO BE COVERED

1 Keeping Quiet

Pablo Neruda

Imaginary poetry → Introspection & retrospection

Introspection → Judging self

retrospection → to Judge past actions


WELCOME TO OUR TEAM
English
Rocket
Raccoon
YOU ARE GOING TO LOVE
IT HERE!

Welcome

Can’t wait to see you

SHINE

in my Class!



Meme of the day

Topic : Keeping Quiet

Now we will count to twelve
- hours of the day
- Months of the year
- ideal number

no movement

and we will all keep still.

as an earthling - as a human being

For once on the face of the Earth

let's not speak in any language,
- "language divides
- silence unites"

abrupt stillness

let's stop for one second,

and not move our arms so much.
- hands / gestures
- weapons

Stop fighting for power

Imaginary situation





Topic : Keeping Quiet

alliteration + Repetetion

Now we will count to twelve → Opposite ideas → Antithesis

and we will all keep still

For once on the face of the Earth → Personification

let's not speak in any language,

let's stop for one second,

Pun - 1 word 2 meanings

and not move our arms so much.

Anaphora

Weapons Gestures





Topic : Keeping Quiet

Explanation:

The poet urges the reader to count to twelve and maintain absolute stillness. He calls to observe a brief period of silence. The use of number twelve can be associated to the hours of daylight filled with noise generated by human activity.

It can also mean the number of months in a year. Both. things indicate the manner in which our time is drowned in the noise that we create continuously.



Topic : Keeping Quiet

The poet appeals to observe at least once such moment on Earth when no kind of words are used. He suggests using no other language besides the language of silence, for that would provide an opportunity to introspect. He exhorts the reader to stop for a brief time, just a second, and not to flay arms while expressing views. This appeal highlights the practice of humans to speak constantly and reinforce their speech by actions.

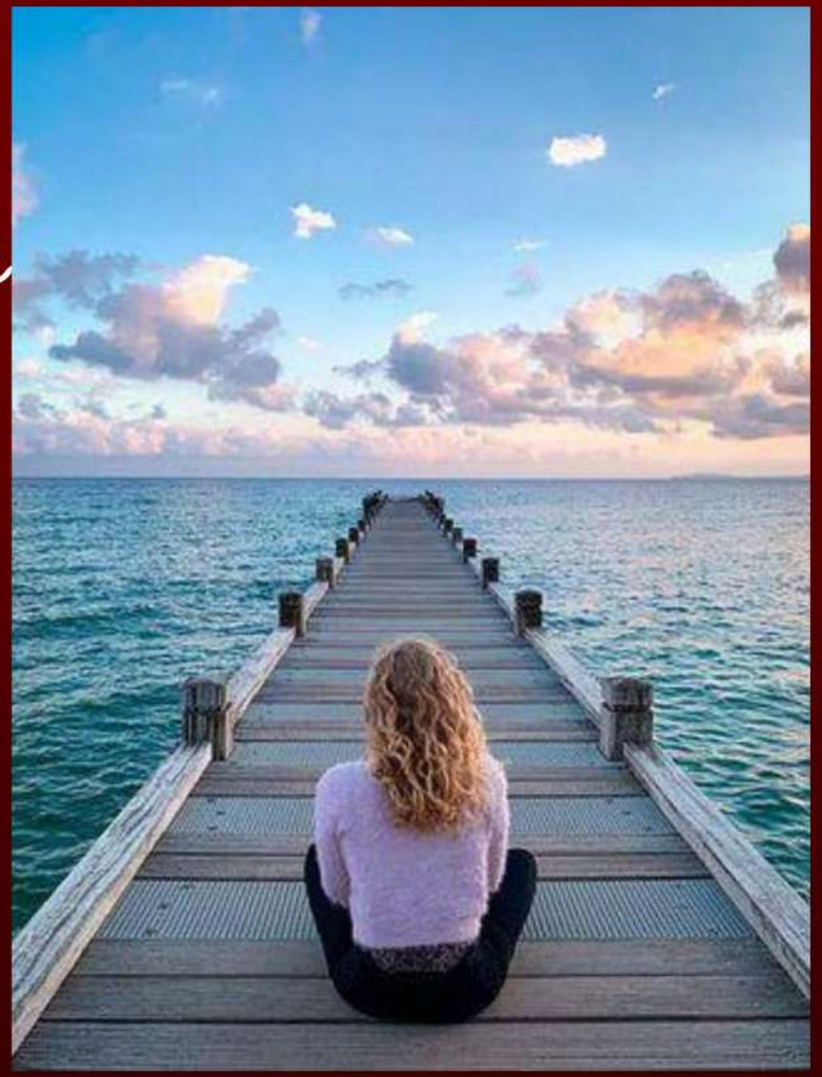


Topic : Keeping Quiet

rare
It would be an exotic moment once in a lifetime
impatience no machines
without rush, without engines, - no technological interference

we would all be together united as one
humans

in a sudden strangeness.
↓
Random अजीब
difficult thing to achieve



Topic : Keeping Quiet

It would be an exotic moment

without rush, without engines,

we would all be together

in a sudden strangeness.



Topic : Keeping Quiet

Explanation:

The poet then attempts to present to the reader the worth of the moment of silence. He believes it to be an exotic moment devoid of distracting hurry or noise. It would have the strange power to bring together all humanity.

That moment of deliberate silence will be free of violence and shall permit time for self introspection.



Topic : Keeping Quiet

Fishermen in the cold sea
would not harm whales
less environmental damage
the pain that we are giving to others
animal cruelty
and the man gathering → blinded by development

salt would look at his hurt hands.
↓
self inflicted pain





Topic : Keeping Quiet

Fishermen in the cold sea
would not harm whales

less environmental damage
the pain that we are giving to others
animal cruelty

and the man gathering → blinded by development

salt would look at his hurt hands.

↓

self inflicted pain





Topic : Keeping Quiet

Explanation:

With more time to think about their actions and awareness about their power, men will exhibit their free will and stop harming their surroundings.

The poet gives the examples of a fisherman not harming whales and a man collecting salt stopping a while to examine his own wounds.



Topic : Keeping Quiet

war over land
environmental damage

Those who prepare green wars,

nuclear warfare atomic warfare → preparators of war
wars with gas, wars with fire,

win to celebrate
victory with no survivors,

would put on clean clothes → clean character
→ pretend to be innocent

and walk about with their brothers — nation's citizens

in the shade doing nothing. — as if innocent

↳ hiding their reality

hypocrisy of powerful people.



politicians.



Topic : Keeping Quiet

Those who prepare green wars,

wars with gas, wars with fire,

victory with no survivors,

would put on clean clothes

and walk about with their brothers

in the shade, doing nothing.





Topic : Keeping Quiet

Explanation:

The poet refers to conflicts over land and air to drive home the point that the outcome of such wars results in losses for all participants. These wars bring a kind of victory which cannot be celebrated since it does not leave behind any survivors. A time zone of silence would make us aware about this bitter reality.

When such a conscious effort for introspection will be made, men would shed their bloody war garments and adorn unsoiled clothes i.e. adopt a fresh approach to life.



Topic : Keeping Quiet

This approach would encourage everyone to move together like brethren under the soft and embalming shade in place of violence and rage of conflict. Then no one will have to struggle in the race of one-upmanship because nothing would be required to be done when peace would have been acquired.



Topic : Keeping Quiet

self introspection

What I want should not be confused

with total inactivity. → lazy, lethargic, sleep.

Life is what it is about; → its about keeping our lives moving

I want no truck with death. ✓

utilise the time for your betterment

↓

I want no person to die due to less knowledge about whats going on.



Topic : Keeping Quiet

What I want should not be confused

with total inactivity.

Life is what it is about;

I want no truck with death.



Topic : Keeping Quiet

Explanation:

Clarifying his views about 'doing nothing' the poet says that his plea for stillness should not be mistaken for passivity or lethargy. He urges to look at life honestly for its simplicity. Life should not be interpreted as something complicated. It is a very simple experience of existing in harmony with our surroundings and appreciating the beauty of quietness within and around us. His desire not to have 'truck with death' is an idiom that connotes having nothing to do with the end of life.



Topic : Keeping Quiet

He wants to live life peacefully and quietly without bothering about any jerks or impediments caused by an integral part of human lives - death.



Topic : Keeping Quiet

we see only development

If we were not so single-minded

even if it costs us mental peace and health

about keeping our lives moving,

Silence all around

and for once could do nothing,

perhaps a huge silence interrupting point

might interrupt this sadness blinded by development ✓

of never understanding ourselves we dont understand the consequences of our action

Ultimate reality

and of threatening ourselves with death ✓ → life a purposeful life



Topic : Keeping Quiet

If we were not so single-minded

about keeping our lives moving,

and for once could do nothing,

perhaps a huge silence

might interrupt this sadness

of never understanding ourselves

and of threatening ourselves with death.



Topic : Keeping Quiet

Explanation:

The poet explains the benefits of 'a huge silence' by asking the reader to consider the situation when none of us would make deliberate efforts to move our lives further.

That moment, when all of us would break the self. inflicted barriers of time, routine and habit, that moment of 'inaction' would.



Topic : Keeping Quiet

is your teacher

Perhaps the Earth can teach us

as when everything seems dead

and later proves to be alive.

Now I'll count up to twelve

and you keep quiet and I will go.

work hard in silence and let your success make noise

think about everything that I told you



Topic : Keeping Quiet

Perhaps the Earth can teach us

as when everything seems dead

and later proves to be alive.

Now I'll count up to twelve

and you keep quiet and I will go.




Barren land

Topic : Keeping Quiet

Explanation:

The poet finally takes us to Nature to understand the simplicity that nuns the cycle of life. He asks us to learn from Earth which appears still and lifeless from afar but as we observe closely it is full of busting life Everything which is born on earth goes through the cycle of growth to serve the purpose for which it is sent to earth by God. It then degenerates and ends in death only to make way for new and young life to follow the same cycle Having presented his philosophy, the poet leaves the reader alone to sit in silence and personally experience the power of quietness. The central idea of the poet, his call to observe silence and introspect our selves, resounds at the end signifying the sincere desire of the poet about keeping quiet.

Topic : Keeping Quiet

Now we will count to twelve

and we will all keep still.

For once on the face of the Earth

let's not speak in any language,

let’s stop for one second,

and not move our arms so much.



Topic : Keeping Quiet

It would be an exotic moment

without rush, without engines,

we would all be together

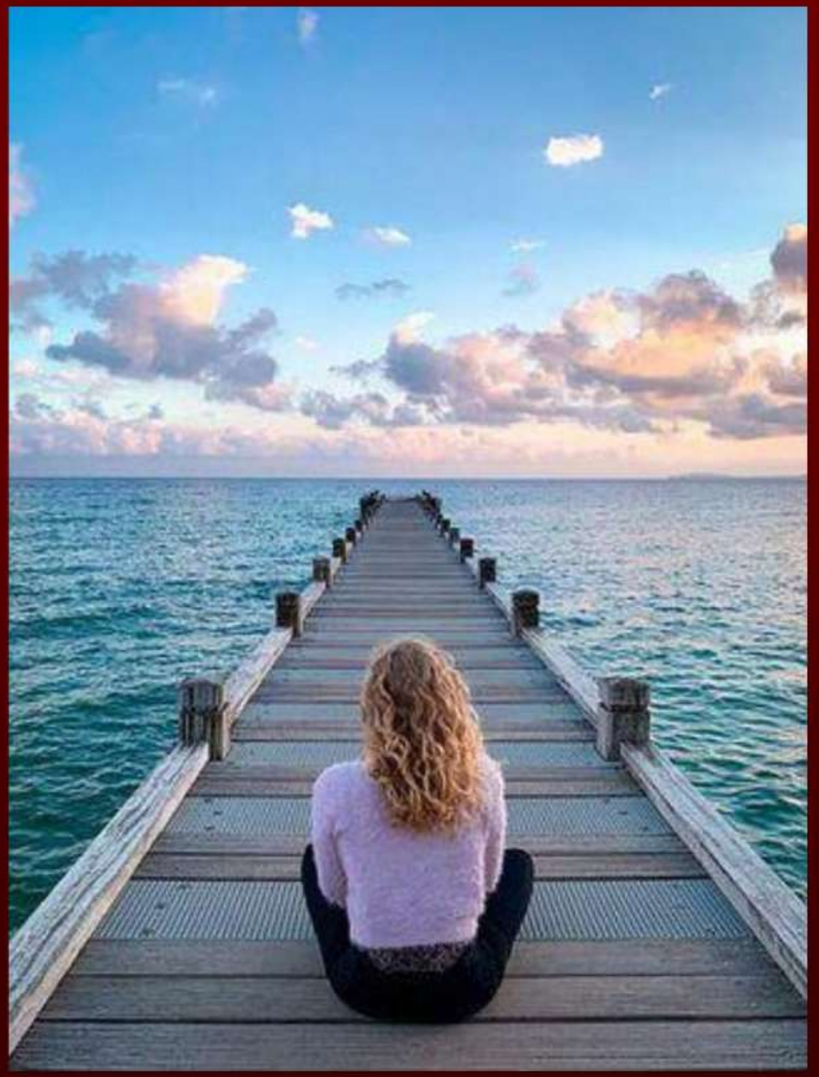
in a sudden strangeness.

Repetation

Alliteration

Alliteration

focus - emphasis on minimum involvement of humans and technology



Topic : Keeping Quiet

Fishermen in the cold sea — transferred Epithet — Adj used for a bigger meaning

would not harm whales

and the man gathering

Alliteration

salt would look at his hurt hands.

cold sea

↓

cold is used for human emotions of cruelty, indifference





Topic : Keeping Quiet

Those who prepare green wars, (war over land)
wars with gas, (nuclear) wars with fire, (atomic)
} Symbolism of destruction

victory with no survivors, (Irony)

would put on clean clothes → Alliteration, Transferred epithet (character - to prove their innocent)

and walk about with their brothers

in the shade, doing nothing.





Topic : Keeping Quiet

What I want should not be confused

with total inactivity.

Life is what it is about;

I want no truck with death.

↓

Hyperbole



Topic : Keeping Quiet

If we were not so single-minded

about keeping our lives moving,

and for once could do nothing,

perhaps a huge silence

might interrupt this sadness

of never understanding ourselves

and of threatening ourselves with death.



no punctuation

Enjambment

Topic : Keeping Quiet

Perhaps the Earth can teach us (Personification)

as when everything seems dead

and later proves to be alive.

Now I'll count up to twelve

and you keep quiet and I will go. ✓



QUESTION

#Q. What does the title of the poem suggest?

1. Being dumb
2. Noise
3. Unhappiness
4. Maintenance of silence ✓



QUESTION

#Q. What does the poem convey?



1. The necessity to be happy and enjoy life
2. The necessity to introspect, understand and have feelings of brotherhood
3. The necessity to work quietly and be serious in life
4. None of these

Judge

भाईचारी

QUESTION

#Q. What can human beings learn from nature?

1. The concept of beauty
2. The value of keeping quiet
3. To be happy
4. The concept of life after death



QUESTION

#Q. What is always alive even when everything seems to be dead or still?

1. Mountains
2. Rivers
3. Sun
4. Earth and nature



QUESTION

#Q. 'Truck with death' means

↓ literal meaning

1. Dead soldiers
2. Mass killing of truck full of ~~pilgrims~~ citizens ✓ how naine people are
3. Truck carrying coffins for the dead
4. Truck transporting inflammable substances ✗

Simple/ साधारण/ भोले

(B)



QUESTION

#Q. Pablo Neruda was a _____.

1. English
2. French
3. Indian
4. Spanish



QUESTION

#Q. What is the essence or message of the poem?

to Judge past actions

1. Introspection and retrospection to be more peaceful and be in harmony ✓
2. To prosper by earning lots of money
3. To be happier by creating big families
4. To reach out to more people

(A)



QUESTION

#Q. Why does the poet want us to walk about with our brothers doing nothing?

reference based Ques

1. He wants to promote laziness
2. Then we will have peaceful discussions instead of wars
3. He wants us to involve in social networking
4. He is promoting gossip

B



QUESTION

#Q. According to the poet, what creates barriers?

1. Interactions
2. Reactions
3. Fighting
4. Languages ✓



QUESTION

#Q. Why does the poet ask people not to speak?

1. Because it creates noise
2. He doesn't like noise
3. It makes things unpleasant
4. Because he wants people to ponder over the result of their activities



QUESTION

#Q. How is keeping quiet related to life and can change our attitude?

1. It makes us inactive
2. It makes us introspect
3. Helps to develop new thinking process
4. All of these



QUESTION

#Q. Why does war lead to a victory with no survivors?

1. Everyone dies fighting
2. People are so busy
3. People are indifferent
4. None of these



QUESTION

#Q. In the sentence – “Perhaps the Earth can teach us”, the Earth has been _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _.

1. immortalised
2. revered
3. condemned
4. personified



QUESTION

#Q. What does number 12 represent?

1. Hours of the day and months of a year
2. Earth
3. Clock
4. Cricket players



QUESTION

#Q. What does the poem Keeping Quiet teach us?

1. How to maintain silence
2. Not to make noise
3. Speaking creates noise
4. To have feelings of brotherhood



QUESTION

#Q. ‘Not move our arms’ what does this expression refer to?

1. Sit quietly
2. Stand quietly
3. Stop talking
4. Stop working



QUESTION

#Q. **Identify the figure of speech used**

"Now we will count to twelve"

1. Alliteration
2. Oxymoron
3. Metaphor
4. All of these



QUESTION

#Q. What should not be confused with total inactivity?

1. No war
2. A statue
3. Talking people
4. Stillness and silence



QUESTION

#Q. What can be a cure or an antidote to violent actions?

1. Non-violent peace talks
2. Sermons
3. Green wars
4. Practice of silence



QUESTION

#Q. What is the sadness in the poem that the poet speaks about?

1. Violence because of thoughtfulness of the people
2. Unnecessary movement
3. Speaking aloud
4. Injuring one's hands



QUESTION

#Q. What does the earth symbolise?

1. Perseverance and new beginning after seeming still
2. Stillness and being fixed
3. Greenery and nature
4. Prosperity and growth



QUESTION

#Q. Why does Pablo Neruda urge us to keep still?

Ans. Stillness is essential for calm reflection and quiet introspection. We hear the voice of conscience in moments of silence. The poet is convinced that most of human ills and miseries are caused by man's hurry and rush to do things. The poet wishes that we may withdraw ourselves from our undesirable actions and keep still for a moment.

QUESTION

#Q. Why shouldn't we "speak in any language" and "not move our arms so much"?

Ans. People of the world speak in different languages. They indulge in unnecessary debates and disputes. Most of these arguments lead to destructive wars. The poet urges people to stop speaking in any language. They must speak through their hearts. So far men have moved their arms only to harm others. Therefore, the poet wants that they should not move their arms so much. Let these arms rest for once. Let a feeling of mutual understanding , be created among human beings.

QUESTION

#Q. What alternative does Pablo Neruda suggest instead of indulging in wars?

Ans. Instead of indulging in wars, the people must come out in their best dresses with then- brothers. They should go out for a walk under the shady trees and enjoy themselves doing nothing. This would bring the feeling of togetherness among them.

QUESTION

#Q. How does the poet distinguish ‘stillness’ from ‘total inactivity’? Why does Neruda saw I want no truck with death?

Ans. Pablo Neruda is in favour of stillness or silence. We remain still and quiet for sometime. On the other hand, total inactivity is a permanent suspension of work. It is just like death. ‘Stillness’ should not be Confused with ‘total inactivity’. Life goes on as usual. There can’t be anything like total inactivity. The poet refuses to associate with death or deal with it.

QUESTION

#Q. Why does the poet fee! that we should not be so single-minded'?

Ans. People are generally single-minded. They want to focus on only one thing. They want to keep their lives going. They are ever busy in their pursuit. The poet wishes that they would not be so much absorbed with always remaining on the move. They must have some respite or rest. They too need peace or silence.

QUESTION

#Q. Why do men become sad? How can this sadness be overcome?

Ans. Men fail to understand themselves. They are always threatening themselves with death. When they realise their failure to understand themselves they become sad or helpless. Fear of death also makes them sad. Only a huge silence' can interrupt this sadness. Such silence will do them good.

QUESTION

#Q. How might a huge silence interrupt the sadness of men?

Ans. Men never understand themselves. Nor are they ever sure of their actions. They face another tragedy. Due to their own actions, they are threatening themselves with death. This realisation makes them helpless and sad. Only a huge (long) silence might interrupt this sadness and do them some good.

QUESTION

#Q. What is Man 'single-minded' about?

Ans. Man has a single-minded focus upon progress and advancement. He does so without thinking about the consequences of his actions that help him to continue moving ahead.

AI Board Booster: **Student se Super Student**

Ek aisa course jo **AI ke use** se aapki Board prep level-up kare

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Course at a glance

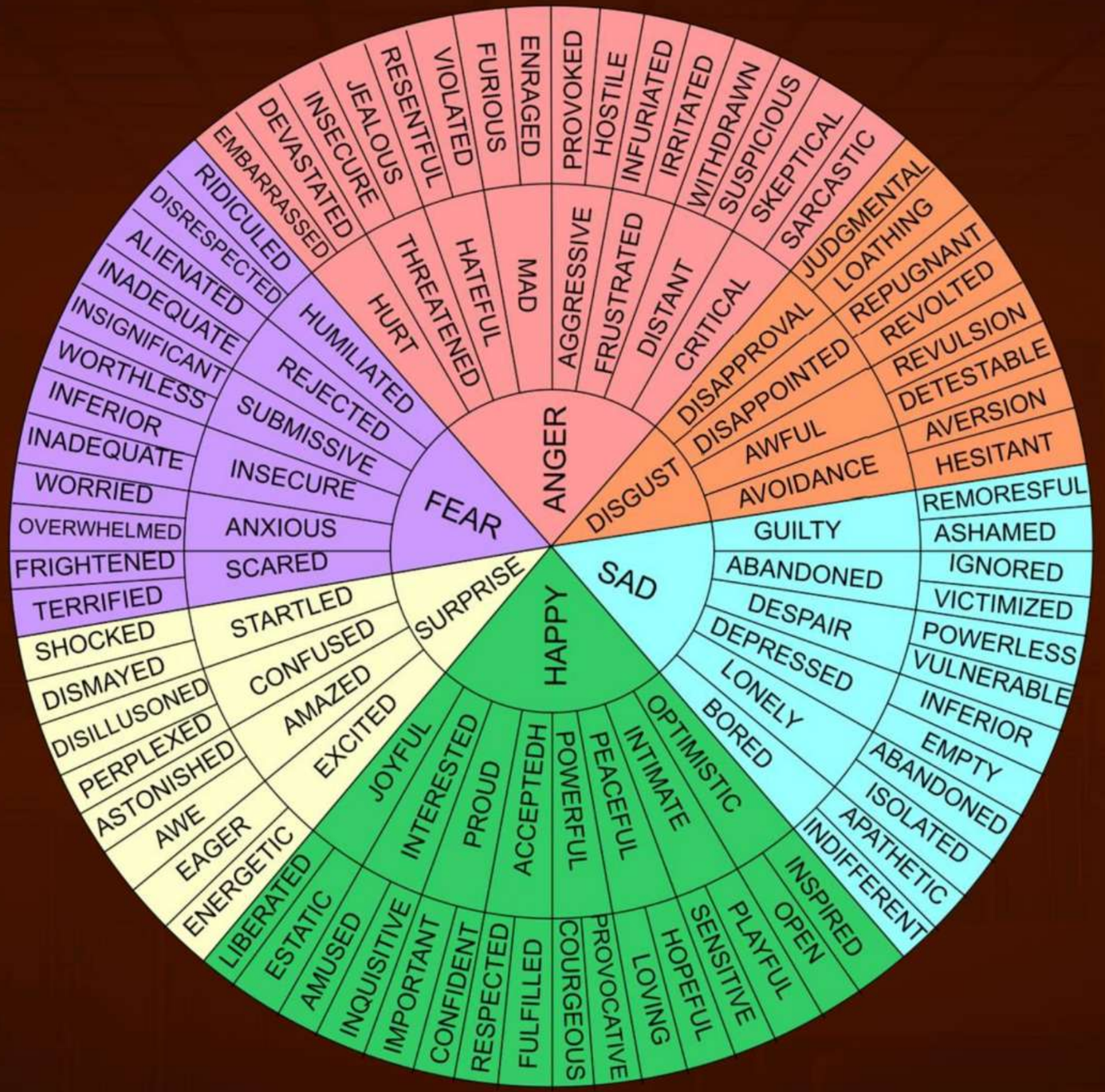
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- **Fee:** ~~₹2500~~ → **₹799** for Uday & Parishram paid users *(coupon in tray)*

Limited seats - Offer ends soon

QUOTE OF THE DAY

"Your future is created by what you do today, not tomorrow. Stay focused, stay consistent, and success will follow."


Enjoy?
Yes
No
94.35%
BYE, BYE.
yarn.co


ANGER
FEAR
DISGUST
SAD
HAPPY
SURPRISE
HURT
THREATENED
HATEFUL
MAD
AGGRESSIVE
FRUSTRATED
DISTANT
CRITICAL
DISAPPROVAL
DISAPPOINTED
AWFUL
AVOIDANCE
HUMILIATED
REJECTED
SUBMISSIVE
INSECURE
ANXIOUS
SCARED
GUILTY
ABANDONED
DESPAIR
DEPRESSED
LONELY
BORED
OPTIMISTIC
INTIMATE
PEACEFUL
POWERFUL
ACCEPTEDH
PROUD
INTERESTED
JOYFUL
STARTLED
CONFUSED
AMAZED
EXCITED
EMBARRASSED
DEVASTATED
INSECURE
JEALOUS
RESENTFUL
VIOLATED
FURIOUS
ENRAGED
PROVOKED
HOSTILE
INFURIATED
IRRITATED
WITHDRAWN
SUSPICIOUS
SKEPTICAL
SARCASTIC
JUDGMENTAL
LOATHING
REPUGNANT
REVOLTED
REVULSION
DETESTABLE
AVERSION
HESITANT
REMORESFUL
ASHAMED
IGNORED
VICTIMIZED
POWERLESS
VULNERABLE
INFERIOR
EMPTY
ABANDONED
ISOLATED
APATHETIC
INDIFFERENT
INSPIRED
OPEN
PLAYFUL
SENSITIVE
HOPEFUL
LOVING
PROVOCATIVE
COURGEOUS
FULFILLED
RESPECTED
CONFIDENT
IMPORTANT
INQUISITIVE
AMUSED
ESTATIC
LIBERATED
RIDICULED
DISRESPECTED
ALIENATED
INADEQUATE
INSIGNIFICANT
WORTHLESS
INFERIOR
INADEQUATE
WORRIED
OVERWHELMED
FRIGHTENED
TERRIFIED
SHOCKED
DISMAYED
DISILLUSONED
PERPLEXED
ASTONISHED
AWE
EAGER
ENERGETIC

THANK YOU

Journey to the ... Earth